

2026 Chevrolet Traverse LT AWD vs. Traverse LT AWD

Same vehicle. Two equipment levels. One clear value decision.

HERE'S MY TAKE

Choose the **\$47,445 Traverse** if the \$2,225 difference fits your budget. You get easier-to-clean Evotex seating and a useful visibility package for a large three-row SUV. Choose the \$45,220 vehicle when minimizing purchase price matters most; its engine, AWD system, fuel economy, warranty, towing capability, and core safety equipment are the same.

What we compared

Two new U.S.-market 2026 Chevrolet Traverse LT AWD models in Mosaic Black Metallic, each with a 2.5L turbo gasoline engine, eight-speed automatic transmission, seven-passenger seating, 18-inch wheels, a spare tire, and factory trailering equipment. **Fuel match: gasoline vs. gasoline.** Prices below are factory MSRP from the supplied window stickers, not negotiated or out-the-door prices.

Category	Value configuration	Equipped configuration
Sticker price	\$45,220	\$47,445
Powertrain	2.5L turbo / 8-speed automatic	Same
Drivetrain / seats	AWD / 7 passengers	Same
EPA rating	20 city / 24 highway / 21 combined	Same
Towing	Up to 5,000 lb with included equipment	Same
Cargo	Up to 98 cu. ft. behind first row	Same
Warranty	3 yr/36,000 mi comprehensive; 5 yr/60,000 mi powertrain	Same
NHTSA label	5-star overall; 4-star rollover	Same

The Chevrolet specifications shown above are common to both vehicles. The cargo figure is the model's maximum with seats folded; actual usable space depends on passenger configuration. Both stickers show the same government crash ratings.

What the extra \$2,225 buys

Equipment	\$45,220 vehicle	\$47,445 vehicle	Practical meaning
Floor Liner Package	Included (\$425)	Included (\$425)	No difference
Seat trim	Jet Black cloth	Jet Black Evotex (\$1,000)	Easier cleanup and a more finished cabin
Driver Confidence Package	Not included	Included (\$1,225)	Better visibility and added convenience
Price difference	Baseline	+\$2,225	4.9% above the lower sticker

Inside the Driver Confidence Package

HD Surround Vision Makes parking and maneuvering this 204-inch SUV easier. Rear Camera Mirror Keeps the rearward view open when passengers or cargo block the conventional mirror. Rear Pedestrian Alert Adds awareness when backing in busy lots or driveways.	Traffic Sign Recognition Displays recognized road signs for added situational awareness. 120-volt power outlet Useful for travel, family gear, and light-duty devices. Key card Provides an additional access option beyond the standard key fob.
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Why choose each

Choose the \$45,220 Traverse This is the value play. It gives you the same road manners, AWD traction, towing equipment, fuel economy, warranty, and nearly all of the important standard active-safety systems. Choose it when keeping the vehicle price down matters more than upholstery and camera upgrades.	Choose the \$47,445 Traverse This is the better family and long-term-use configuration. Evotex should be easier to wipe clean, while Surround Vision and the camera mirror help every day in parking lots, garages, and when the cabin is full.
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How each choice fits

With no customer-specific priority order supplied, this review uses a general family-use assumption: safety and daily usefulness first, then affordability and long-term ownership value.

First Principle	\$45,220 Traverse	\$47,445 Traverse
Pillar One - Safety	Strong standard package, including adaptive cruise, blind-zone steering assist, rear cross-traffic braking, reverse automatic braking, enhanced emergency braking, and an HD rear camera.	Adds Surround Vision, Rear Pedestrian Alert, Traffic Sign Recognition, and the Rear Camera Mirror. These improve awareness, especially around a full-size family SUV.
Pillar Two - Affordability	Saves \$2,225 at MSRP while retaining identical mechanical capability and fuel economy.	Costs 4.9% more. The value case is strongest when the negotiated price gap is lower than the sticker difference.
Pillar Three - Lifestyle Fit	Best for a straightforward seven-passenger vehicle when cloth seating and the standard camera are sufficient.	Better for children, pets, frequent cargo, and tight parking. Evotex and upgraded cameras are practical rather than merely decorative.
Pillar Four - Long-Term Value	Lower initial investment and the same warranty reduce upfront exposure.	Evotex and visibility equipment may help future desirability, but should not be assumed to recover their full original cost at resale.

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What it may cost you to own

Fuel, routine maintenance, warranty coverage, tires, and expected mechanical exposure should be essentially the same because the two vehicles share the same drivetrain, wheels, and EPA rating. The confirmed ownership-cost difference begins with the **\$2,225 higher acquisition price** of the equipped vehicle. A full total-cost estimate would require the negotiated selling prices, financing terms, insurance quotes, annual mileage, and expected ownership period.

Do not pay a higher interest rate or accept a materially worse loan merely to obtain the equipment package. If both deals carry equivalent terms, the extra features are reasonably priced for frequent family use.

My recommendation

The **\$47,445 Traverse** is my preferred configuration. The extra cost purchases equipment you are likely to notice regularly: easier-care seating, better visibility, and a useful household power outlet. The recommendation flips to the **\$45,220 Traverse** if the added \$2,225 strains the budget, if you prefer cloth, or if you do not like the camera mirror after trying it.

What you should know before signing

1	Compare the actual selling prices, not only the two MSRPs.
2	Sit in both cloth and Evotex seats and compare comfort, grip, and heat retention.
3	Drive the equipped vehicle using the Rear Camera Mirror; some drivers need time to adjust their focus.
4	Use HD Surround Vision in a tight parking space and decide whether it has real value for your routine.
5	Obtain an insurance quote using each VIN before choosing.
6	Have the dealer confirm in writing that there are no open VIN-specific recalls and verify campaign 26V114, if applicable, has been completed before delivery.

Sources and disclosures

- Factory window stickers supplied by the customer: equipment, MSRP, destination charge, EPA ratings, warranty, and government crash-rating labels.
- [Chevrolet Traverse specifications](#): power, cargo, towing, and model equipment. Checked July 29, 2026.
- [NHTSA 5-Star Safety Ratings](#): rating methodology and consumer guidance. Checked July 29, 2026.
- [NHTSA campaign 26V114](#): certain 2026 Traverse vehicles may require an electronic owner-manual remedy; applicability must be checked by VIN. Checked July 29, 2026.

No negotiated prices, incentives, financing, taxes, insurance quotes, or customer-specific annual mileage were provided. Those omissions could change the affordability conclusion but not the equipment comparison.

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Get with Terry and work out the details.

Review the numbers and next steps at terryethompson.com/math.

